socio-economic position, which exacerbates their marginalized gender and minority identities (Kamler 2015, p. 221). In other words, gender-based violence experienced by Kachin women stems from poverty at the level of the household, which in turn is tied to broader socio-economic structures, such as organized crime. Trafficking networks are embedded in the shadow economy, as is the regional trade in logging, precious stones, and drugs, all of which have resulted in an increase in female-headed households (KWAT 2014).

There is then a clear link between material insecurity at the level of the household, political marginalization within the IDP camps, and gender-based violence. Importantly, female soldiers' decisions to join or support the army are related to the insecurity these women and their communities experience, inside and outside the IDP camps, as one interviewee noted:

> When the conflict broke out again, my family fled to this area to live in the IDP camps. I was not involved in political activities before this. My father joined the local militia troops but he was killed in action. KIO and KIA are very important for us, very important part of our lives, because in the serious situation like this, almost every Kachin family has to serve at least one or two family members because we need to protect and defend our motherland.[18]

GENDERED INSECURITY AND GENDERED RELATIONS IN THE HOUSEHOLD

A feminist political economy approach highlights the importance of analysing gender relations at the level of the household for understanding women's experiences of insecurity and access to justice, political decision-making, and power. This approach renders the structural causes of insecurity visible, as it understands gender relations as being produced within a framework of political and economic power. In particular, it allows for a focus on household intra-bargaining dynamics in shaping women's ability to challenge gender norms both within the home and in the public sphere (Agarwal 1997). A feminist political economy approach then helps to make visible the relationship between women's ability to negotiate gender norms, and their experiences of material and physical insecurity: for example, taking responsibility for the wellbeing of households' impact on women's access to power, resources, and justice. The number of female-headed households in Kachin State ranks third in the country, with more than a quarter of all homes headed by a woman